

SPY/INFILTRATOR

DRIVE

STATEMENT

DUTY:

6

FAITH:

5

JUSTICE:

5

POWER:

5

TRUTH:

7

The truth is what you make it.

SKILL

FOCUSES

BATTLE:

5

COMMUNICATE:

6

Deceit

DISCIPLINE:

5

MOVE:

5

UNDERSTAND:

7

Danger Sense, Traps

Traits: Imposter, Spy

TALENTS

Ransack: When they attempt an Understand test to search an area, they can spend 2 Threat to reduce the Difficulty of the test by 1, and to halve the amount of time the test takes.

Assets: Cibus Hood, Lockpicks, Memocorder

A person who can find information about a rival is invaluable in House or Imperial politics. One who can penetrate to the very heart of an enemy's household is worth their weight in spice. On Arrakis a successful spy or infiltrator gains rich rewards. Failure or detection is, however, often fatal. Or worse.

EXAMPLE SPIES/INFILTRATORS

- ☞ **Tellia** poses as a trader in an Arrakeen market while collecting intelligence for a 'friend' who is a Harkonnen employee.
- ☞ **Haley**, posing as a skilled chef, has infiltrated the House kitchen and awaits a signal to administer chaumas (ingested poison).
- ☞ **Aury**, a talented musician, has befriended the heir to a House and is obtaining information for rivals while giving baliset lessons.

SCENARIO HOOK

An infiltrator placed in a rival House sends a trusted messenger to inform the player characters they fear their cover has been blown. They request extraction, but the messenger says the infiltrator has been 'turned' by the player characters' rivals and the rescue operation is really a trap.



TECHNICIAN

DRIVE STATEMENT

DUTY:

5

FAITH:

6

My skills will keep us running.

JUSTICE:

4

POWER:

4

TRUTH:

5

Smelling of grease and oil and with the always-present jingle of extra parts rattling in their pockets, clever technicians keep Arrakis humming. These mechanics and tinkers can replace ornithopter blades or clean sand out of a water reclamation unit with their eyes closed. A good technician is worth their weight in spice.

On Arrakis, nothing is easy. Creativity and flexibility are the keys to survival on this parched planet. And technicians are no exception. More than one has had to improvise an air filter from a discarded stillsuit to get a broken carryall into the sky before a sandworm arrives to destroy profits. The planet's blistering heat and endless sand are a technician's biggest challenges.

Though the job may not be a glamorous one, Arrakis would grind to a halt without the quick-thinking and tenacious technicians employed there.

SKILL FOCUSES

BATTLE:

3

COMMUNICATE:

4

DISCIPLINE:

6

Precision

MOVE:

4

UNDERSTAND:

6

Advanced Technology, Deductive Reasoning

Traits: Technician

TALENTS

- ✧ **Rigorous Control:** They can use Discipline instead of any skill in an extended test, and reduce the requirement by 1 if the skill was already Discipline.

Assets: Technical Access, Tools, Vision Enhancement Goggles

EXAMPLE TECHNICIANS

- ✧ **Terilynn Hasan** works for smugglers and has a knack for fixing anything mechanical. Her favorite things are broken Holtzman field generators she can repair.
- ✧ **Alik Vidiri** builds their own vehicles and races them, legally or illegally, whenever they have the chance. Groundcars? Ornithopters? If it moves, Alik will make it go fast.
- ✧ **Alahhaois Ranum** is one of the many technicians who repairs carryalls and spice harvesters. He has saved more than one harvesting expedition on the scorching sands of Arrakis.

SCENARIO HOOK

A technician comes to the player characters, concerned that they've been requested to make some components that they suspect are going to be part of a thinking machine. The person ordering the parts did so through a proxy, so the player characters must discover who ordered them and what they are planning to do. The technician is terrified of what will happen to them if people think they are complicit in breaking Butlerian edicts. However, could the technician be trying to frame the player characters and their House as creators of thinking machines?

TLEILAXU MASTER

DRIVE

STATEMENT

DUTY:

5

FAITH:

6

JUSTICE:

3

POWER:

5

TRUTH:

7

Science holds the answers.

SKILL

FOCUSES

BATTLE:

3

COMMUNICATE:

6

Neurolinguistics

DISCIPLINE:

6

MOVE:

5

UNDERSTAND:

7

Genetics, Faction Lore (Tleilaxu)

Traits: Tleilaxu, Biologist

TALENTS

- ☞ **Masterful Innuendo:** They can conceal a hidden message in a conversation by adding 1 to the Difficulty of the Communicate test.

Assets: Face Dancer, Illicit Recordings, Ixian Damper

All Tleilaxu look odd. Most have sharpened teeth (whether this is innate or acquired is not known). Some are abnormally short; others have greyish complexions. Whatever the differences, their appearance makes humans from other planets feel uncomfortable, as if the nature of the Bene Tleilax's services — artificially grown limbs and organs, gholas returned from the dead, and, of course, the Face Dancers — were not disconcerting enough. Tleilaxu masters use this discomfort to their advantage.

EXAMPLE TLEILAXU MASTERS

- ☞ **Azarz**, having placed a Face Dancer in a rival House, will ensure the Face Dancer will report to their client, at a cost.
- ☞ **Hintrock** has recently arrived in Arrakeen with a ghola of the dead spouse of a senior House member.
- ☞ **Pergale** has much to offer. What do you want? A super-efficient limb? Eyes that double as binoculars? Pergale can arrange it.

SCENARIO HOOK

A Heighliner has disappeared. A spy in the market reports she saw a Tleilaxu Master pass a package to a Guild Agent. Could this have been a Tleilaxu experiment with synthetic spice? Or are the two incidents unrelated?



WATER SELLER

DRIVE STATEMENT

DUTY:

4

FAITH:

4

JUSTICE:

5

POWER:

6

Everyone wants water.

TRUTH:

4

SKILL FOCUSES

BATTLE:

2

COMMUNICATE:

6

Bartering, Gossip

DISCIPLINE:

4

MOVE:

4

UNDERSTAND:

5

Traits: Water Seller, Merchant

TALENTS

- ☞ **Subtle Words:** They can create a new trait whenever they spend Threat for extra dice on a Communicate test.

Assets: Small Group of Thugs, Water, Wealth

With their distinctive cry of "Sook Sook!" water sellers can be found all over the city of Arrakeen. As a precious commodity, water fetches a high price and many water sellers can become quite rich. However, the majority are quite poor, often buying water in bulk from a merchant and selling it on for a minimal profit. Some more desperate souls even sell part of their own vital water rations to make ends meet. But despite the hardships, no water seller ever lacks for customers.

EXAMPLE WATER SELLERS

- ☞ **Manan** is a wealthy water merchant who loves to flaunt his wealth and overcharge his customers.
- ☞ **Binda** is an old lady who sells water as a sideline and loves to gossip with her customers.
- ☞ **Nia** is actually an informant for a rival House and is always on the lookout for secrets.

SCENARIO HOOK

A water seller complains that their wares have been stolen, but the people they accuse insist the seller has actually drunk their own stock. But given the accused are agents of the player characters' House, is there more to the dispute than meets the eye?

RIVAL HOUSES



It is not only the agents and allies of the Houses of the Landsraad that might be lined up against the player characters, but whole Houses themselves. In a universe where most people owe loyalty to one House or another, who you serve is an important question, and counting one House as a friend always means making an enemy of others. Where alliances and vendettas stretch back in some cases for thousands of years, peace between certain Houses is an impossible dream.

In this chapter we offer a few example Houses, which might be allies or enemies of the player characters' House. They might be old friends or rivals, or they may be a new connection whose allegiance depends on the player characters.

Each House is defined quite loosely to allow the gamemaster to adapt it to suit their campaign. Each one just needs a name and a reason to encounter the player characters. While each House has a theme, it is important to remember that none of them are 'one trick ponies'. Every House in the Landsraad has the means to protect itself and its holdings. So, just because the theme is art or science, it does not mean the House has no standing military or never sells any crops. However, its theme is the way it distinguishes itself from the other Houses of the Imperium and the area where it is at its most powerful. Remember, anyone who controls an entire planet is not to be underestimated.

MILITARY HOUSE

This House is renowned for its military might. It commands well-trained and well-armed soldiers, all led by battle-hardened generals. The Military House might have built such a force to feel safe, or so they might hire themselves out as mercenaries.

The noble family ruling the House revolves around strict military protocol. Heirs are trained extensively in various forms of combat, and those who hope to lead the House are driven to excel. This might make the members of the House quite bullish, but they respect strength and may also follow a code of honor.

As a Great House: The Great Military House is a master of all things military. House Corrino, ignoring its Imperial benefits, is a Military House whose famed Sardaukar soldiers strike fear into the hearts of even the most powerful Great Houses. Other Great Houses of military might exist in the Imperium, but are careful to show their undying allegiance to the Golden Lion Throne, lest the Emperor turns their eye upon them.

As a Major House: The Major Military House is a tiger you do not want to wake. However, for all its fighting power it is still reliant on the Guild to move its troops around the universe. An invasion is an expensive operation. But this may lead to a deadly cycle of the House needing to make more conquests to pay an ever-growing debt to the Guild.

As a Minor House: The Minor Military House is more of a specialist. It cannot produce the best army and weapons and strategy, etc., so it works to be the best at one particular aspect. This makes it a useful friend, as it might have just the right specialty to fill a gap in an ally's fighting force without being so powerful that a betrayal cripples them.

Resources: The resources and holdings of a Military House are all rated in their use on the battlefield. If something cannot have a weapon added to it, be it a person or a vehicle, it is of little use to the Military House. However, these Houses may need a good source of metal ore so they can construct their weapons and war machines.

Ruler: If the ruler of this House is getting old, their fighting days may be behind them but they are still an expert tactician. If they are young, they may still be spoiling for a fight, possibly against the advice of their advisors. But it is equally possible the ruler may have tired of war and fighting and now tries to avoid it. This may lead to more militant factions in the House looking to replace them.

As an Ally: The uses of a Military House as an ally are quite obvious. Their force of arms might give the player characters' House the 'teeth' they lack. However, the player characters had best be careful they don't rely too much on the Military House. Those same troops might easily turn and take control of any installations they are guarding.

As an Enemy: A Military House is usually easy to see coming. If their strength is in force of arms, they usually meet any potential conflict head on with firepower. This makes them a little easier to politically flank. For instance, a large Guild bribe would stop them from moving their forces off planet. Unfortunately, outthinking such a House may make them all the more dedicated to proving their superiority. It is unlikely that any conflict can be considered resolved by them unless it has been settled on a battlefield.

Domains: The following list represents likely domains of this style of House at each level; feel free to mix and match to fit your story. Military Houses focus on producing military power in various forms and supporting that power, so expect secondary domains to support the primary: food supplies or small arms for their soldiers, or tactics and shields for officers, etc.

MINOR HOUSE

Primary Domain (1): Military Machinery (Armored Fighting Vehicles)

Secondary Domain (1): Military Produce (Ammunition or Engineers)

MAJOR HOUSE

Primary Domain (1): Military Workers (Soldiers)

Secondary Domains (2): Military Produce (Small Arms) and Farming Produce (Military Rations)

GREAT HOUSE

Primary Domain (2): Military Workers (Pilots) and Military Machinery (Armored Fighting Vehicles)

Secondary Domains (3): Military Produce (Shields), Farming Produce (Military Rations), and Military Understanding (Specialty Tactics)

ADVENTURE HOOKS:

- ❖ In the player characters' darkest hour, when their House might be overrun by a rival House, this Military House offers its aid and services. They might see the characters as noble and just and therefore undeserving of destruction. Maybe they are also an enemy of this House and see this as a chance for them to strike a blow against a shared rival. Or perhaps they are playing a long game where the attack on the player characters' House was nothing but an attempt to place them in the debt of this Military House.
- ❖ Whatever the motivations of this House, they are placing extensive military aid at the service of the player characters. Do the characters accept their terms, even the hidden ones? Or do they face the enemy alone and perhaps gain respect from them for their tenacity, or disgust for the way the characters waste their peoples' lives?

- ❖ The player characters' House has discovered a secret technique, method, or weakness of a Military House. This House is not aware that the characters know about this closely guarded secret. Do the characters approach them openly and offer it back to them, or offer to pay them for having gained this knowledge for free? This might raise the characters' prestige within the Landsraad, and if they are an honorable House the characters may have just purchased their friendship, ended an old grudge, or even made an ally.
- ❖ Or do the player characters keep it secret amongst their House as a weapon to employ against them if they ever have thoughts of betrayal? Perhaps the characters can even sell it to other enemies of this House, but then the Military House might discover the leaked information and compensate.
- ❖ Just or unjust, this House feels that the player characters' House has wronged them in some way. They have called one or more members out to face them on the field of honor, in either an honor battle or a duel where one or more members settle the dispute via ritualized armed conflict.

Is this a common pattern of this House, using these methods of bullying to stomp or weaken other Houses? Or do they have a real case against the player characters' House? They have refused all other forms of compensation and the Landsraad sees this as an equitable form of dispute resolution, less wasteful than klan for both sides. Champions are allowed, so if the characters are not well-trained in the art of war, perhaps one of their militant allies can stand in for them, in exchange for a favor.

ESPIONAGE HOUSE

This House strikes at their enemies from the shadows or lures other Houses to their side via indirect means, often leaving the new ally unaware of the maneuvering behind the scenes. This House thrives on plots within plots and may even employ a strict secret police force within their own populace to better control enemy activities, but also foster growth of new agents.

The noble family rules with a subtle but strong hand. Rivals die of mysterious illnesses, while friends seem to be lucky without reason. Often these Houses' rulers have multiple heirs and pit them against each other so that the strongest or luckiest survive to rule as ruthlessly as they do. Perhaps the rulers bait their heirs into coup attempts against them.

As a Great House: The Great Espionage House rules from the shadows with the ability to apply unorthodox political pressure upon even the most powerful Houses and entities within the Empire. CHOAM, the Spacing Guild, and even the Bene Gesserit step with care around this House, as they never know where the poisoned dart might fly or for what reason. House Harkonnen is an infamous example of just

such a House. The Baron and his twisted Mentat were both masters of intrigue and deception so refined that they broke the mental training of a Suk doctor and, at the time, brought House Atreides low through this impossible betrayal.

As a Major House: It is best to leave viper nests alone. This House has mastered one area of espionage and likely offers its services to other Houses, such as employing Face Dancers on singular missions using connections to the Bene Tleilax, or purchasing the diplomatic secrets of a rival House from this Espionage House. Even still, at this level, this House might want to hide their abilities from other Houses, as they might seem less than honorable.

As a Minor House: Specializing in one area of espionage, this House might train superb diplomats or craft an expert tool for assassins, or even anti-espionage equipment, but if they know how to build it they know how to subvert it. This House goes to great lengths to hide their full subversive abilities so as to not draw the ire of the Great Houses or lose the trust of their own House Major.

Resources: The resources and holdings of this House only matter insofar as they further the agenda of the Ruler of the House. If purchasing 5,000 tons of whale fur that rots on the docks is needed to hide an assassin or smuggle out important documents worth far more to the right buyer, then such purchase is justified, and even better if the whale fur can be sold, even if at a loss.

Ruler: Old rulers are uncommon for this type of House as they become too slow to survive the schemes and plots of their heirs. The rare older ruler of an Espionage House is a master of terror all should fear. Younger rulers may still be jumping at shadows and poorly estimating the abilities of their rivals as they try to settle into their role as a spider at the center of the web that is their House.

As an Ally: Espionage Houses make for poor allies as they often have fewer scruples about selling out an ally for their own ends. However, if a true alliance can be formed with such a House then the benefits of excellent intelligence, the deaths of rivals, and ways of subverting the system others must follow are unparalleled.

As an Enemy: It is rare for a House to know if they are true enemies of an Espionage House. For they often accept apologies, payments for slights, and profess friendship all while planning a House's destruction for whatever reason suits them. They go to unusual lengths and often employ convoluted plans to strike back at their enemies so that no one knows that it was the Espionage House who drove the dagger into their back.

Domains: The following list represents likely domains of this style of House at each level; feel free to mix and match to fit your story. Espionage Houses often cloak their subterfuge activities in more innocuous domains. Secondary domains are often presented as the primary domain of an Espionage House to outsiders. They are the cloak that hides the dagger.

MINOR HOUSE

Primary Domain (1): Kanly Workers (Assassins)

Secondary Domain (1): Artistic Workers (Traveling Performers)

MAJOR HOUSE

Primary Domain (1): Espionage Understanding (Counter-intelligence Techniques)

Secondary Domains (2): Espionage Machinery (Surveillance Devices) and Espionage Workers (Infiltrators)

GREAT HOUSE

Primary Domain (2): Kanly Produce (Poisons) and Kanly Workers (Infiltrators)

Secondary Domains (3): Industrial Workers (Servants), Science Expertise (Pharmacists), and Espionage Produce (Blackmail information).

ADVENTURE HOOKS:

- ✧ A powerful member of the Espionage House, who is neither a rival nor ally, comes to the player characters' House seeking asylum and wishes to join. They claim to bring secret knowledge with them that benefits the House, and it does appear, at short glance, that the information they have is useful. But can they be trusted? Are they truly trying to defect? Or are they a double agent trying to infiltrate the characters' House on behalf of their own House? Would it be better to take them in, kill them, or turn them back over to the other House?
- ✧ The player characters have discovered that there is at least one mole in their House who is feeding information back to their enemy, the Espionage House. There may be more. The players need to uncover who the mole or moles are and decide whether to leave them in place and feed bad intelligence back to the enemy, or if they should purge them and see if they can clear out any other internal spies that might have taken up root.
- ✧ A minor House that is friendly towards the player characters reveals that they are not what they seem. Instead of the innocent merchants they have long purported to be, they are, in fact, an Espionage House. They tell the characters this so that they might ally with them against a common enemy. They offer to help train the player characters' own intelligence operatives and improve their counter-intelligence systems. In exchange, they would like help in the characters' domain. Do the players trust them? Is this House being upfront and helpful, or are they just setting the characters up for a betrayal to the third House that they purport to hate as much as the characters do?



TECHNOLOGICAL/ INDUSTRIAL HOUSE

Anything can be overcome with the proper application of superior technology and engineering know-how. This is a common phrase that the engineers and scientists who flourish and prosper within this House often echo. Their armies may not be as well-trained or numerous as those of a Military House, but they have better armor, better vehicles, and better everything. They may not know every secret, but they do have the technology to gather intelligence more efficiently than others. And while their art, farms, or religious institutions may not be as subtle or celebrated, they certainly are efficient and sophisticated.

The ruling family of this House is highly educated and well-versed in the various technologies and industries that they produce. They may even push the boundaries of the Butlerian proscriptions, but if they do they know to keep such things well hidden or risk the Houses of the Landsraad joining forces to destroy them. They even see their own family as a thing to be improved with technology. They may have multiple senior family members trained as Mentats, and the ruler themselves might have Mentat training.

As a Great House: The Great Technological and Industrial Houses are the masters of innovation and the backbone of industrial production within the Imperium. Everything from the grand Heighliners of the Spacing

Guild to the ubiquitous utensils used by the countless masses on every planet are invented, engineered, and produced in the sprawling factories of the Grand Technological and Industrial Houses and their satellite minor Houses. The Spacing Guild and other great Houses buy the very best from such a Great House. House Richese and House Vernius are both examples of at times Great Technological Houses, and later the Bene Tleilax assume that role more directly after taking over Ix.

As a Major House: A Major Technological/Industrial House can be considered the very best in one area, or at least rivaling the innovations of one Great House. They have integrated their supply chain to be able to not only create, but produce as well, and maybe even provide the raw materials needed to develop their primary product. In addition, they are not without one form of defense: Many other powerful Houses would be displeased if their supply of the goods produced by this House were to slow down or stop.

As a Minor House: A Minor Technological/Industrial House is often one step in a line of production of some major specialty good, or a major producer of some common good like furniture. While they cannot corner the market with what they produce and innovate with, they still can be useful as their sheer ability to fabricate goods dwarfs major Houses with other focuses. And if given the proper motivation and resources they can push themselves to work above their own standards for short times.



Resources: The resources of this House are focused on one thing: increasing the profits and production of the House. Military, artistic, and espionage resources are only developed up to the level where they prevent major profit losses for the House, and no further. Everything in this House is bent toward squeezing profit from whatever domain this House focuses on, and beyond that it does not matter.

Ruler: Rulers of these Houses tend to be older as they are often less involved in plots and ploys and directly dangerous ventures. They also usually have access to medicines and technologies that extend life beyond the longevity benefits of spice. Younger rulers often come into power when something has befallen their previous ruler and often look to shake things up. Sometimes this means employing their massive production or technological edge toward dangerous ventures like war or espionage, or instead focusing on mundane changes like increasing quality or output.

As an Ally: Militaristic Houses love alliances with technological- and industrial-focused Houses as superior production and technology often gives an edge when superior numbers are not there. Technological- and industrial-focused Houses desire material that is difficult for them to produce, access to technological breakthroughs, and highly-skilled personnel; in exchange, they offer beneficial trade deals and access to their best finished products and technologies.

As an Enemy: Often these Houses do not strike directly at their enemies. They instead prefer to pay others to do the fighting for them. Be wary of militant Houses suddenly disliking you for little cause or espionage Houses trying to cozy up to you if you are enemies with a powerful Technological or Industrial House. Those other Houses have likely been paid off or offered sweetheart deals in exchange for your destruction. If they do take a direct tack against you, then expect highly sophisticated and advanced technological attacks that might be difficult to counter.

Domains: The following list represents likely domains of this style of House at each level; feel free to mix and match to fit your story. Technological and Industrial Houses focus on building up vertical or horizontal monopolies related to their primary domain.

MINOR HOUSE

Primary Domain (1): Industrial Produce (Rare Refined Alloys)

Secondary Domain (1): Industrial Produce (Mined Metallic Ores)

MAJOR HOUSE

Primary Domain (1): Science Understanding (Technological Research)

Secondary Domains (2): Science Expertise (Scientists) and Industrial Expertise (Engineers)



GREAT HOUSE

Primary Domain (2): Industrial Machinery (Spacecraft) and Science Understanding (Spacecraft Drives)

Secondary Domains (3): Industrial Workers (Ship Builders), Industrial Expertise (Foremen), and Science Workers (Lab Assistants)



ADVENTURE HOOKS:

- Either through direct or indirect means, the player characters' House has discovered that another House has been creating machines that could fall under the Butlerian-Jihad-proscribed thinking machines. No one else knows. This new technology they are employing has already revolutionized their House's abilities. They have seemed friendly toward the characters' House in the past. Perhaps the player characters could ally with them to gain access to these machines. If they do, both Houses could be wiped out for breaking the dictates against thinking machines. The player characters may decide it is better to destroy the other House and take the spoils for themselves. Then again, the characters don't think anyone else knows.
- A large number of advanced military craft that appear to be painted in the colors of the player characters' enemy have been delivered to them. The Spacing Guild is adamant that the delivery is not a mistake, and the House that produced the craft claims that no such craft were sent to the characters, and if so, then they should return them. However, the Guild refused to explain how the characters should go about returning them. The craft would give the characters a significant advantage against their enemy in a battle, but it might turn the current cold war with them hot, and who knows what gremlins or Trojan horses have been implanted in these craft.
- While working on another project, the player characters' scientists and engineers have had a massive breakthrough in a new area of technology. It would revolutionize the current system (entertainment, small arms, transportation, housing, etc.). Another House controls that market, and if the characters pushed this revolutionary product they would surely make an enemy for life. However, this competing House has stagnated for decades and the market deserves this innovation. Could the characters ease their pain by offering them something in exchange, or do they crush the other House with this product and then hit them with spies and/or military when they are at their weakest?

ARTISTIC/ RELIGIOUS HOUSE

Drawing upon millennia of tradition in the arts of humanity, the Artistic and Religious Houses create experiences that draw humanity closer to the great ideas, and closer to God. While they may outwardly seem very different, Artistic and Religious Houses are at their core similar in how they go about producing experiences for their patrons. Artistic Houses produce art of various sorts ranging from the profane to the profound. Religious Houses produce experiences similar to those profound Artistic Houses. They both require hierarchical leaderships that focus legions of dedicated personnel towards creating these moments that awaken humanity from their slumber of selfish personal focus to the greater goals of the Imperium and God.

As a Great House: These Houses have produced some of the greatest thinkers and artists in the history of the Imperium. Art like the Golden Lion Throne or the great palaces of the Imperium are but minor works compared to the litany of art installations these Houses display on their planets. Great Religious Houses closely follow the strictures of the Orange Catholic Bible and often act as leaders in questions of religion and morality within the Empire, often producing religious leaders as advisors to other Houses. The Bene Gesserit could arguably be considered a Religious Great House, as their Reverend Mothers have infiltrated almost every major and great House in the Imperium. However, they are not on the Landsraad, avoid direct political and military power, and instead focus on more ineffable concerns.

As a Major House: A Major Artistic or Religious House can be considered the source for a single type of artistic or religious product. They have cornered the market in something like the most couture fashion of the Imperial Court, or they craft the finest religious jewelry like prayer bead necklaces with Zensunni mystic icon portrait pendants. Much like the Industrial Houses, they are not seen as a direct military or espionage Threat, and the disruption of their products would bring the ire of many powerful Houses.

As a Minor House: As a House Minor, an Artistic House is likely an emerging art trend that recently became popular. Or they are a custodian of art trends past and struggling to maintain relevance. Religious House Minors are more likely to contain shrines at locations of minor miracles or holy places. They often have monastic orders associated with them that produce personnel for the Orange Catholic faith.

Resources: Artists and priests are the two most important resources either House can produce, as they are the source of all great art and wisdom created by these Houses. Keeping them happy and highly productive is their primary concern, and all resources are aimed at

these endeavors, be they the latest tools and resources for them to create, or other personnel aimed at reducing stress and boosting artistic output and keeping religious figures going as they preach the word of God.

Ruler: Old and young rulers of Artistic Houses push the boundaries to keep their artistic creations fresh and exciting for patrons. They cultivate friendships with as many other Houses as possible, both as potential security and as potential customers for their creations. Religious rulers do much the same, but their focus is on saving the souls of their allies and keeping them on a righteous and holy path, not deviating into proscribed technologies or sins of disfigurement.

As an Ally: Many Houses have Religious and Artistic Houses as allies, as the goal of both is to befriend as many Houses as possible. You can expect them to provide support to win over the hearts and minds of your enemies, and keep your House well-received by others of similar mindset. They invite you to the best parties and the hottest shows, or involve you in august and wise discussion about the need for morality within the halls of the Imperium.

As an Enemy: Everyone seems to be against you when you make enemies with a powerful Artistic or Religious House. Their social power and whisper campaigns bar the doors of power to you. You are snubbed at every turn, and word that you are unfashionable, gauche, or immoral begins to spread amongst other Houses. Even if not true, such esoteric rumors are harder to dispel with displays of power or scientific breakthroughs than when rumors of weakness in military or technological realms are spread. One cannot become fashionable or moral when the decision makers of what is fashionable and/or moral are arrayed against you.

Domains: The following list represents likely domains of this style of House at each level; feel free to mix and match to fit your story. Religious and Artistic Houses have eclectic domains, as they might pursue multiple avenues of expression. In addition, they sometimes also expand into domains that support potential patrons or industrial bases when their artistry has a great need for certain resources. It is also worth noting that Artistic/Religious Houses are just as likely to have teeth as any other House. Actors and performers often make very good spies, and it is good to remember that (officially at least) the Face Dancers of the Bene Tleilax are entertainers.

MINOR HOUSE

Primary Domain (1): Artistic Understanding (Advertising)

Secondary Domain (1): Artistic Workers (Actors)

MAJOR HOUSE

Primary Domain (1): Artistic Understanding (Fashion)

Secondary Domains (2): Industrial Produce (Textiles), Industrial Workers (Tailors/Dressmakers)

GREAT HOUSE

Primary Domain (2): Artistic Produce (Broadcast Entertainment) and Religion Understanding (Religious Philosophies)

Secondary Domains (3): Artistic Machinery (Production Studios), Religion Expertise (Clergy), and Religion Produce (Religious Texts)

ADVENTURE HOOKS:

- ✧ A troupe of performers who were trained by one of the player characters' enemies, but declare themselves independent performers, has arrived at the characters' House. They wish to spend time performing in the House's territory. They are considered popular throughout the Imperium, and slighting them would hurt the characters' image among the Landsraad. However, they also brought along an incredible amount of electronic gear that is legitimately for productions, but can also be used for espionage purposes. Do the player characters dare snub them? And if they let the troupe perform, are they merely a distraction for another form of attack, or are the characters being too paranoid and risking the troupe's ire from their distrust?
- ✧ Disaster! One of the senior members of the player characters' House has become the laughingstock of the Landsraad for their unfashionable wardrobe choices. Even Imperial guards and functionaries titter behind the characters' backs as they deny appointments to meet important officials to conduct business. One even laughed in a character's face after making a joke about their own wardrobe! Clearly, the House's enemy, an Artistic House, is behind these attacks, but how to stop them? A makeover of the characters' House attire might stem the tide, or perhaps leaning into the archaic and backwards dress of the House is the way to go. The respect of Houses not constrained by fashion can only deepen.
- ✧ The player characters' ally, one of the Religious Houses, notes their piety and has invited them to sit on an Orange Catholic faith advisory council within the Landsraad. However, the characters' other ally has significant enemies within that organization and may cut ties if the characters join them. But if the characters refuse to join, they risk angering the first House. How can the characters keep both Houses happy, or at least mollified, without losing valuable contracts and much-needed goods and services from one or both? They must tread carefully, for if they misstep here they could destroy both relationships and lose it all by trying to please everyone.

AGRICULTURAL HOUSE

Considered by many to be the most basic, yet vital Houses, the Agricultural Houses (or Farming Houses) focus on feeding the people of the Imperium. Their task is monumental and never-ending, and it affects every member of society from the lowliest slave up to the Emperor himself. After the spice melange, food is considered the single most important resource that keeps the Empire running. Without enough food to feed the countless masses, chaos would reign supreme. Many other Houses produce large amounts of food as a way to feed their people, but these Houses focus on producing enough food to feed the large numbers of people on planets that do not or cannot produce enough food for their people. Thus, the Spacing Guild has become a major part in the food supply chain transporting mind-boggling amounts of foodstuffs every day in a dizzying web of supply and demand.

The ruling families of Farming Houses are often considered backward and parochial because of the simplistic and basic domain(s) of their House. Many do not realize the highly advanced levels of production, co-ordination, and management that leaders of such Houses need to successfully dedicate entire planets — or at least continents — to producing food, preparing it for market, shipping it off-world to planets that need it, and turning a profit after each growing season. Many have embraced that simplistic outlook and often embrace strong views on honor and loyalty.

As a Great House: These Houses feed countless people, although they likely know just how many they can feed down to the number of meals they provide per credit spent in production. They may focus on one or two staple foods, like pundi rice or golden wheat, but they also must have major skills in management, logistics, and basic defenses to protect their massively vulnerable production facilities, including fields that cover continents. House Atreides is a similar example, as it is often overlooked because their primary domain is pundi rice, yet their history of integrity has attracted some of the most skilled advisors and leaders to their House.

As a Major House: These Houses often control one major sought-after specialty food source, like cultivating turtlebugs or growing grapes for the coveted Caladanian wine, as well as specializing in domains that support this production. Ecologists and meteorologists are trained and paid handsomely by these Houses as they give insight into the future needs of their lands and thus their future productions and profits.

As a Minor House: These Houses often act as a staple producer for a larger House that focuses on other ventures. Often Great and Major Military and Industrial Houses have farming-focused House Minors that are built solely to provide the necessary supplies for the soldiers and workers of their parent Houses. Or they focus

on providing a singular farming domain that is no longer as popular or as useful as other sources of nourishment. A minor House might also focus on an area outside production, such as processing or packaging deliveries from a producing House.

Resources: The resources of Farming Houses are aimed at producing the largest amount of quality crops in the shortest amount of time. Timed watering systems; experts skilled in biology and the genetics and care of plants and livestock; and advanced soil and water management techniques are their highest priorities. In addition to crops, some food production Houses might focus on precooking agricultural produce, such as preparing cake and other baked goods from the raw ingredients they produce or import.

Ruler: Farming rulers tend toward the stoic and those capable of the long-distance view. They understand the most basic needs of humanity, and that to fulfill those needs takes massive long-term planning to not only succeed but survive. Older rulers often focus on adapting to political change and understand that even when disaster strikes, you must pick up and move on. Young rulers see the enormous burden they have taken on and often fight for their beliefs as if the very life of the Imperium is at stake.

As an Ally: All ruling Houses worry about feeding their people. Having a Farming House as an ally takes that concern from one of their top priorities to a minor issue as food becomes cheap and plentiful and allows the ruler and their council to focus on other pressing matters. This often-symbiotic relationship frees the Farming House from concerns beyond the need to provide food.

As an Enemy: Nothing is certain when a Farming House is your enemy. The spice melange is the reason the Empire exists, but food is the reason the Empire continues. Cutting off or poisoning food supplies can lead to not only the death of the people of an enemy House, but the death of the House itself.

Domains: The following list represents likely domains of this style of House at each level; feel free to mix and match to fit your story. Most secondary domains within a Farming House focus on supporting the primary domain of agriculture, but often the primary process is simple enough so that other simple domains like natural resource extraction or military training can be practiced.

MINOR HOUSE

Primary Domain (1): Farming Understanding (Advanced Farming Methods)

Secondary Domain (1): Science Expertise (Agricultural Biologists)

MAJOR HOUSE

Primary Domain (1): Farming Produce (Gourmet Cheeses)

Secondary Domains (2): Industrial Machinery (Cheese Production Machinery) and Farming Workers (Cheesemakers)

GREAT HOUSE

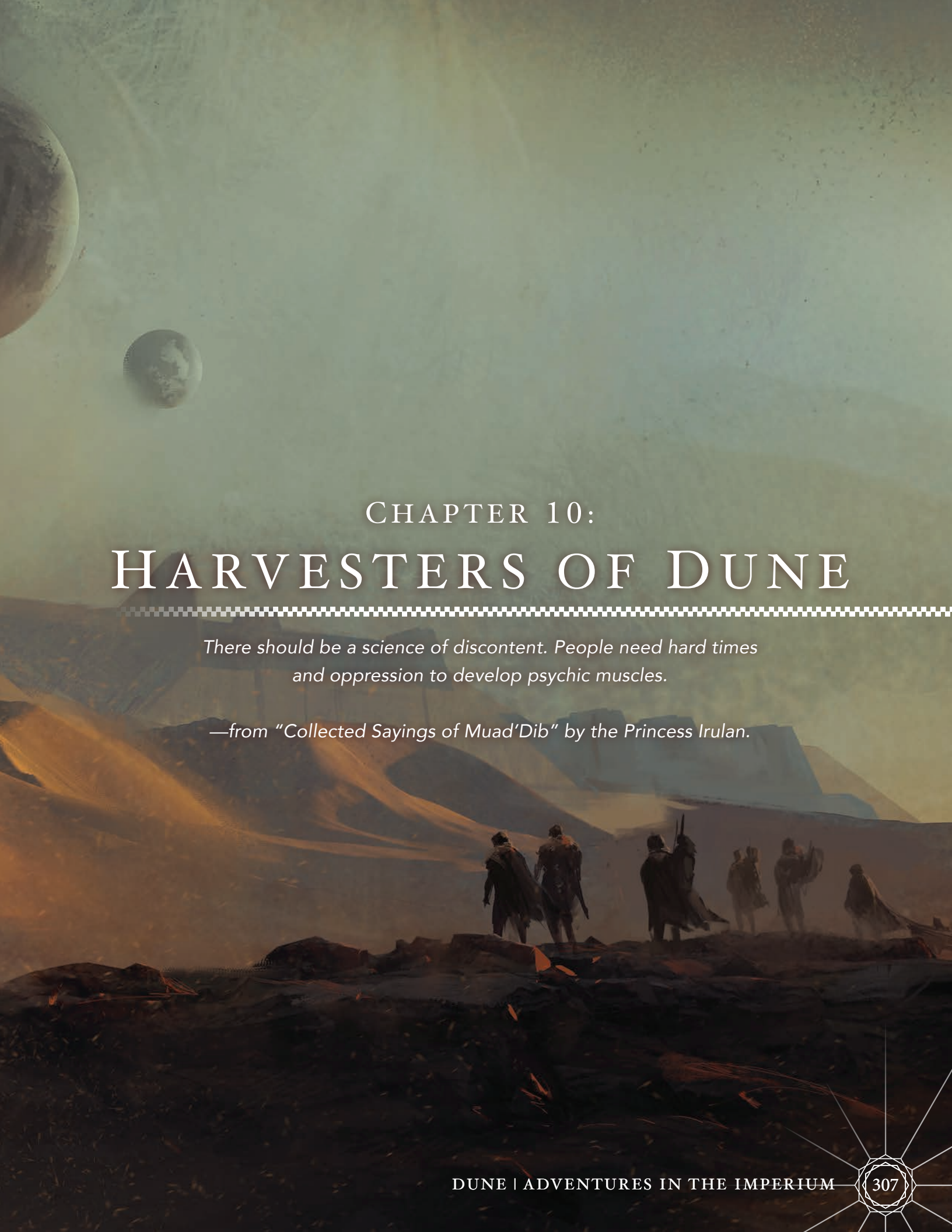
Primary Domain (2): Farming Produce (Beef) and Farming Produce (Sweets/Candy)

Secondary Domains (3): Farming Expertise (Land Managers), Farming Produce (Cattle), and Industrial Machinery (Sweet Production)

ADVENTURE HOOKS:

- ✧ An allied Farming House has asked the player characters for help. A radical preacher has spread their message throughout the lands of this House and now most of the farmers refuse to work until their demands are met. The farmers' demands do not seem radical, but the characters' ally insists that giving in will ruin the current crop and the next harvest as well. They want help eradicating the preacher and forcing the farmers back to work. What do the characters do? They can try to convince their ally to leave the preacher alone, but this might destroy the relationship with them and the favorable trade deals in place. They could instead help eliminate the preacher and break the farmers' strike, but that way leads to bloodshed and violence.
- ✧ The player characters' latest delivery of rice from a Farming House they have a standard trade agreement with has been poisoned. They only learned of it when one of their guards snuck some for a late-night snack and died in agonizing pain a few hours later. The House declares themselves a victim of a setup as their bill of goods to the Spacing Guild shows that the rice was untainted when delivered to the Heighliner. The Spacing Guild also has proof that they never tampered or let anyone tamper with the rice while they possessed it. The player characters didn't poison their own rice, and no one had enough time to poison all of it after delivery. Therefore, someone is lying. Who is the true enemy here? The Guild? The Farming House? Or a 3rd House or party that somehow defeated the security measures of one or both other parties?
- ✧ Two Farming Houses have come to the player characters to resolve their dispute. During a border skirmish started by the first House, the second House started a fire that spread widely and destroyed millions of hectares of both of their lands. The first House wants the second House to pay for it, but the second House refuses because they only started the fire by accident, they claim, and in defense of the first House's attack. They don't want the Landsraad involved because the disputed land was being used to grow illegal narcotics for both Houses. They promise to cut the player characters in if they arbitrate.





CHAPTER 10: HARVESTERS OF DUNE

*There should be a science of discontent. People need hard times
and oppression to develop psychic muscles.*

—from “Collected Sayings of Muad’Dib” by the Princess Irulan.

ADVENTURE OUTLINE



he player characters are members—or notable supporters—of a Noble House with spice mining rights on the planet Arrakis. A crisis threatens the House's profits this year: one of their flying carryalls, and its small fleet of ground-based harvesters—has a poor spice productivity record. The carryall in question is named after a historical Harkonnen lord: the Graf Von Dreissen, but its crew know it as 'The Grief'.

The player characters are dispatched to the carryall to discover the cause of the Grief's poor productivity and to take whatever actions are necessary to eliminate problems and improve matters.

WHEN IS THE ADVENTURE SET?

This adventure is set during the final period of the Imperium, before the events of the book *Dune*, and concerns player characters whose House currently has fiefdom over spice harvesting on the planet Arrakis. If the players have already created their House but do not have holdings on Arrakis, you can discuss changing the era to one when their House does have rights on the planet.

Alternately, they can play as another House for this adventure—for example House Harkonnen, the brutal stewards of Arrakis in the decades leading up to the assumption of the Arrakis fiefdom by House Atreides.

Finally, they might also be running a spice harvesting operation under a franchise from another House. This might be as a favor, or simply because the House in control of Arrakis is feeling stretched. While this usually means access only to the less profitable parts of the operation, the potential for wealth and power cannot be underestimated.

The business of spice harvesting is known to be a dirty, dangerous affair, and tensions between the House, the hard-bitten spice workers, and the elusive, unfriendly local Fremen are often strained and threaten to boil over into open hostilities, whether through industrial action or acts of physical conflict.

This adventure is a great introduction to *Dune* if you have not played before. However, if you have the *Heirs of Dune* you might play this adventure after completing the Starter Set as part of the ongoing campaign as the player characters go about managing their new fiefdom.

STRUCTURE

The adventure consists of three scenes. The first is set aboard the massive carryall Graf Von Dreissen, 'the Grief'. There, the player characters experience first-hand the poor management, shoddy equipment, and tension among spice workers that is partly responsible for the low productivity. They also can avoid a lethal equipment malfunction which proves to be the result of industrial sabotage.

The second scene takes place in the trackless sands of Arrakis, when the player characters' 'thopter crash-lands and they are forced to march out of the desert to safety before the myriad dangers of the desert bring death to them all. The player characters must face hostile Fremen and the ever-present threat of Dune's colossal sandworms.

In the third scene, the player characters reach the dubious sanctuary of the spice harvester Alberich and its shady crew of spice workers. No sooner do they discover the identity of the saboteur than an incoming sandworm is spotted, forcing the player characters to make difficult decisions in a short space of time. They must choose between escaping the worm, saving the raw spice cargo, or dealing with the saboteur before the great sandworm arrives to consume the harvester and everyone on board.

ASSETS

The player characters should all be equipped with Arrakis-manufactured water-retaining stillsuits (assets of Quality 0), as they are going about the surface of the desert planet. Unless a player has specifically indicated that their suit is of Fremen manufacture—rare and costly—they are of the inferior type more commonly available to all.

As this is assumed to be a routine inspection of an industrial facility needing (at most) a little managerial troubleshooting, the player characters are unlikely to arrive on the Grief accompanied by a large retinue of staff or guards, though they can of course create supporting characters during play using Momentum or Threat (**Supporting Characters**, p.136). If so, these are limited to members of their personal retinue(s).

Should the players strongly request physical protection, remind them of their characters' personal combat assets, be they melee and ranged weapons, shields, or armor.

ACT I

THE GRIEF

The player characters disembark from a 'thopter in the landing bay of the massive carryall Graf Von Dreissen as it flies over the deserts of Arrakis. The 'thopter—one of the Grief's own—picked them up from their House's estate and they have spent the voyage to the carryall in its cramped and dingy interior. The carryall itself is not much better. It is incredibly noisy onboard the flying factory, and the sweet cinnamon scent of spice pervades the air, mixed in with the baser industrial tangs of grease, oil, and ozone.

They are immediately met and welcomed on board by Jaris Obregon. Obregon is an old friend, relation, or colleague of one or more of the player characters—allow the players to choose who—and she greets them all warmly. The character chosen receives the trait 'Friend of Obregon'.

"It's good to see some friendly faces here! Come, let me show you around."

GUIDED TOUR

Obregon takes the player characters on a tour of the Grief, guiding them through the decks of the carryall, passing through bulkheads and ducking under cabling. Spice workers bustle to and fro, going about their business wearing grimy overalls, some with goggles and breather masks.

Unless the player characters dictate otherwise, Obregon guides them down the decks of the carryall, past the crowded untidy crew quarters, the noisy industrial spice compressor, the deafening engine room, and finally to the lowest deck where a large harvester vehicle is currently being unloaded of its cargo of raw spice. As they move through the ship the characters may **Understand** (average, D1) that the Grief is in a poor state of repair and shoddily maintained, and also that many crew members bear the bruises and cuts of scuffles or beatings.

JARIS OBREGON, SPICE OPERATION MANAGER (NOTABLE SUPPORTING CHARACTER)

Jaris Obregon serves as the overworked second-in-command of the Grief, a thankless role which combines secretary, administrator, and general gofer. She is a minor member of the characters' House, but due to the circumstances of her birth—she was fathered by an heir of the House on a lowly servant—she was seen as something of an embarrassment and eventually sent to work as far away as possible.

Outwardly meek but inwardly seething with resentment and ambition, Obregon has turned traitor to the House and has been sabotaging the Grief's already poor spice production on behalf of her mysterious 'new patron'. She secretly loathes the House that has treated her so badly, including the player character(s), whose friendship toward her she sees as patronizing.

Obregon is the true villain of the adventure, though it is important that this not become apparent to the players in Scene One. The gamemaster should take care to portray Obregon as an ally of the player characters, though not an especially interesting one. She should come across as a friendly but meek member of the House, and something of a middle-management nonentity, not likely to amount to much due to her low station and seemingly modest personality.

She is secretly quite skilled in mechanics and electronics and has received some personal combat training by her father's staff. She also has a few interesting personal assets, courtesy of her new patron, such as a personal shield.

DRIVE	STATEMENT
DUTY: 5	
FAITH: 6	
JUSTICE: 7	I'll get what I'm owed.
POWER: 5	
FAITH: 5	
SKILL	FOCUSES
BATTLE: 5	
COMMUNICATE: 6	
DISCIPLINE: 7	Spice harvesting
MOVE: 4	
UNDERSTAND: 6	Electronics, Mechanics

Traits: Spice Worker, Administrator

Talents:

⊖ **Cautious (Understand):** Obregon may re-roll a single d20 gained from spending Threat.

Assets: Maula Pistol, Second-in-Command, Patron, Personal Shield

THE SPICE COMPRESSOR

The large industrial compressor machine onboard the carryall takes the raw spice gathered by the harvesters and compresses it into solid bricks to be transported off-planet and refined into the myriad of useful spice products which makes Arrakis such a valuable resource.

MEETING THE COMMANDER

Unless the player characters dictate otherwise, the deferential Obregon swiftly escorts the characters to the bridge of the Grief, to meet the carryall's commanding officer, Globus. The blustering Globus, more an incompetent factory manager than a commander, grudgingly greets the characters with the respect due their stations in the House, but with a degree of exaggerated self-importance.

He vastly overstates the difficulties of running the carryall's spice operation, while downplaying any suggestion that the poor condition of the ship and low morale of the crew is in any way down to shortfalls in his management abilities. Globus blames the low productivity on the poor quality of the crews.

A successful average (D1) **Communicate** test identifies Globus as a blustering fool who has little involvement in the daily operation of the Grief. The player characters may make a daunting (D3) **Discipline** test to upbraid him for his poor management. Doing so grants them the temporary trait 'Envoy of my House' to represent pulling rank.

COMPRESSOR MALFUNCTION

At an opportune moment determined by the gamemaster—perhaps in the midst of one of Globus' diatribes about the difficulties of recruiting competent workers on Arrakis—an alarm sounds on the bridge, mercifully cutting him short. It is followed by a scratchy comms message: there is a mechanical malfunction in the spice compressor. All spice processing must halt until the fault is cleared.

If the player characters hurry to the compressor, they arrive in time to see a carryall worker climbing down into the spice-caked machine itself. The worker shouts out to the assembled crew.

"There's a blockage jamming up the compression plates. It's another damned creosote bush. Don't they ever weed the spice before unloading?"

The player characters can **Understand** (average, D1) that the compressor machine's emergency stop button has been thrown, ensuring that the massive metal compressor plates are deactivated so that the worker can safely climb inside to investigate.

Another successful **Understand** test (challenging, D2) reveals that underneath the din of the carryall engines,

there is a low thrum that indicates the compressor machine is still powered on. The worker is in imminent danger of being crushed to death! If so forewarned, the player characters can shout a warning to the worker, try to cut the power somehow (no roll required as the machinery is fairly easy to understand). Or they can bravely try to haul the worker out—a daunting (D3) **Move** test.

If the player characters do not intervene, or are not even present at the compressor, as soon as the doomed worker tugs the mangled creosote bush free of the mechanical jaws, he is bloodily crushed to death by the compressor.

SABOTAGE

The player characters can make a thorough investigation—a daunting (D3) **Understand** test—of the compressor, or another carryall mechanic does so if none of the characters take the initiative. Someone has deliberately and recently rewired the machine's power supply so that it remains powered on, even though the emergency stop button was pressed. That means that the machine was a potential death trap from then on. It was just a matter of time until it jammed and someone climbed down to investigate.

While the player characters consider who might have sabotaged the compressor, the helpful Obregon disappears off and soon reappears with the carryall maintenance log. The log shows the characters that it was a carryall mechanic named Euler who last worked on the compressor.

Obregon obligingly notes that Euler has a record of bad discipline, elaborating that he was recently caught 'being disrespectful'—'Answering back to Globus', she adds—and consequently demoted to work at a distant spice storage depot and reserve processing facility across the desert. The depot is many kilometers away in the desert, but reachable by fast 'thopter flight in under an hour. Though she is not so blatant, everything Obregon says suggests that she believes that the accident was a work of sabotage by a malcontent Euler.

"An act of revenge!"

The scene ends with Obregon leading the player characters to a 'thopter so that they can question this Euler themselves, be he fool or saboteur. If they do not come to this conclusion, it is suggested by the helpful Obregon. If they ask to divert the carryall itself, they are told that such would cause an even greater delay with production, cost valuable fuel, and they would still need to use the 'thopter to land.

Unknown to the player characters, the real saboteur is none other than the friendly Obregon herself. Wary of outsiders continuing to sniff around the Grief and uncovering her activities, the treacherous Obregon has misdirected them toward Euler, to lure them off the carryall. Moreover, she has used her mechanical skills to sabotage their 'thopter. It will never reach the depot...



LORRIMER GLOBUS, CARRYALL CAPTAIN

(NOTABLE SUPPORTING CHARACTER)

Lorrimer Globus is the commanding officer of the Grief. He is a time-serving bureaucrat who has advanced as high as his lack of ability permits and has thus reached the pinnacle of his incompetence. Unimaginative, self-important, and lazy, he lets Obregon handle the day-to-day administration of the Grief.

His favorite problem-solving method is to find a likely scapegoat and brutally punish them, and then make a blustering announcement to the crew over the comms system that the problem has been solved.

Globus resents interference from higher up the command structure—such as the player characters—but grudgingly complies with direct orders. He is happy to see the departure of interfering higher-ups and outsiders, particularly the player characters.

Traits: Carryall Commander, Unpopular

Talents:

- ☞ **Constantly Watching:** Whenever Globus attempts a test to detect danger or hidden enemies, he reduces the Difficulty by 2, to a minimum of 0. In addition, once per scene, he can increase the cost to keep the initiative by +2.

Assets: Carryall Commander, Knife, Servant of the Residency

DRIVE	STATEMENT	
DUTY:	6	
FAITH:	5	
JUSTICE:	5	
POWER:	7	A commander should be obeyed.
TRUTH:	5	
SKILL	FOCUSES	
BATTLE:	5	
COMMUNICATE:	6	Intimidation
DISCIPLINE:	7	Spice Harvesting
MOVE:	4	
UNDERSTAND::	5	

ACT II

'THOPTER DOWN

The player characters take a 'thopter from the carryall and head to the distant storage depot to question the suspected saboteur Euler. But some kilometers out, a mechanical alert blares. Their pilot, Taryn Jellicoe, shouts that the craft's engine has suffered a catastrophic failure. Smoke and fire billow from the engine, visible from the cockpit, and the cockpit begins to fill with metallic-smelling smoke.

The 'thopter starts to lose power and altitude, dropping toward the searing desert below!

GOING DOWN

If a player character chooses to wrest the controls from the pilot, they can attempt to pass a daunting (D3) **Move** test and land the 'thopter rather than letting it crash. They land hard and the 'thopter takes a lot of damage, but there is no serious harm to anyone inside the 'thopter, and they suffer only minor bumps, taking the new temporary trait 'Rattled'.

If the 'thopter is not piloted by a player character, their pilot Jellicoe fails to bring the 'thopter down safely. It crashes to the desert floor, sending the vehicle tumbling violently across the dunes, until it comes to a shuddering stop, half buried in the sand. The pilot suffers a broken leg, and everyone else must pass a challenging (D2) **Move** test to only suffer the 'Bruised' trait. If they fail, they become 'Battered'.

ASSESSING THE DAMAGE

However they get down, the 'thopter is a wreck and cannot be flown. The pilot may be incapacitated. The radio inside the craft is inoperable. The player characters' personal comms devices don't have the range to raise the distant carryall Grief, or the even more distant storage depot.

Smart players may direct their characters to examine their wrecked 'thopter to **Understand** (average D1) what went wrong. Among the burnt remains of the engine they discover a charred but obviously cut fuel line, the source of the engine fire. Was someone trying to murder them before they can uncover the truth of the compressor sabotage?

The stillsuit of one of the player characters—the game-master chooses who, likely based on who was injured—was ripped in the crash-landing. If the player characters check their stillsuits, they discover that a catch pocket on one suit has been slashed open. A rough repair job with tape can limit the water loss, though that player character is still a little low on water.

The player characters can salvage some meager supplies from the wreckage if they think to do so: extra water,

rations, and a medical kit. But the poor maintenance condition of the 'thopter—just as with the carryall itself—means that there is little else of use. No toolkit, no signal devices, no camping equipment. Certainly not a Fremkit.

REVIEWING THE OPTIONS

The pilot Jellicoe can help the player characters review their options. With comms inoperable, there is no way they can complete their journey across the vast, searingly hot desert to the distant storage depot on foot. Their best bet is to head back to the sector of desert where the carryall and its harvesters are operating until they can get within comms range or can signal a scout 'thopter. Nonetheless, this is still a journey of many kilometers across the sand on foot.

If Jellicoe suffered a broken leg in the landing, the player characters must decide whether to be humane and bring her along, though she slows them down, or pragmatically leave the pilot behind, as she expects them to (albeit with a promise to send help).

If the player characters need encouragement to get moving, a successful average (D1) **Understand** test shows a distant crest of sand heading their way. A sandworm has detected the impact of the 'thopter and is coming towards the crash site. They need to hurriedly **Move** (challenging, D2) at least a kilometer from the crash site before the worm breaches the desert surface and consumes the wrecked craft (and possibly Jellicoe). Anyone who fails is able to get to safety but gains the complication 'Exhausted'. Anyone carrying Jellicoe who fails the test cannot escape the worm. They must choose whether to abandon Jellicoe and live or both be consumed. There is no time for someone else to take her. The desert only offers hard choices.

CROSSING THE DESERT

The player characters' trek across the desert is slow, tiring, and thirsty work. After their exertion, the player characters need to drink water to refresh themselves. If they thought to bring extra water from the 'thopter, then they are all fully refreshed. If they did not think to bring extra water, they must rely on their stillsuits, which, unless they are of Fremmen design, are less than optimal and all affected player characters suffer the 'Thirsty' trait. If they have no extra water and did not discover that one of their number has a damaged stillsuit, then that character also receives the 'Weakened' Complication.

Bringing Jellicoe along forces the player characters carrying her to make a challenging (D2) **Move** test, with failure earning them the 'Fatigued' trait.

TARYN JELlicoe, 'THOPTER PILOT

(NOTABLE SUPPORTING CHARACTER)

Taryn Jellicoe is a 'thopter pilot for the carryall Graf Von Dreissen, or the characters' House if that is more appropriate. Arrakis born and bred, she has some desert survival skills which the characters may need. She might also be a Fremen, secretly weighing up the characters' worth/threat to her people. Either way, Jellicoe is honest, extremely pragmatic, and not very talkative.

Traits: Pilot, Arrakis Native

Talents:

None

Assets: Knife, 'Thopter, Stillsuit

DRIVE		STATEMENT
DUTY:	7	I cover the back of those who cover mine.
FAITH:	6	
JUSTICE:	5	
POWER:	5	
TRUTH:	5	
SKILL		FOCUSES
BATTLE:	5	
COMMUNICATE:	4	
DISCIPLINE:	6	Survival (Desert)
MOVE:	7	Pilot (Thopter)
UNDERSTAND:	5	

DRASIL, FREMEN LEADER

(NOTABLE SUPPORTING CHARACTER)

Drasil is the chief of a small band of desert Fremen. Like all Fremen, he is characteristically wary of off-worlders. His people have been much wounded by hostile encounters with the player characters' House of late, and he is proud, so he does not offer the hand of friendship easily. He is curious about these particular off-worlders, however, traipsing across the desert and risking their lives. But he is also accustomed to trading his band's own small spice reserves with smugglers in return for contraband goods like weapons and other technology.

Traits: Fremen, Wary

Talents:

- ☞ **Resilience (Battle):** Drasil may resist defeat twice in a scene when in a conflict using the listed skill.

Assets: Crysknife, Fremen Leader, Fremkit, Stillsuit

DRIVE		STATEMENT
DUTY:	5	
FAITH:	7	The desert takes what it is owed.
JUSTICE:	6	
POWER:	5	
TRUTH:	5	
SKILL		FOCUSES
BATTLE:	7	Short blades
COMMUNICATE:	6	
DISCIPLINE:	8	Command, Survival (Desert)
MOVE:	7	Worm Rider
UNDERSTAND:	6	

FREMEN

A daunting D3 **Understand** test alerts the player characters to the presence of several people hiding up ahead, behind a rocky outcrop. If forewarned, the player characters can quickly prepare, such as arming themselves, changing direction, or splitting up.

Regardless of what they plan or attempt, a group of wary Fremen (see Fremen Warrior, p.280) appears atop the rocks before the player characters, at a distance just beyond close combat weapon range. The Fremen are well-armed and seem ready for a fight. At first, they unnervingly say nothing and make no signal, interested in seeing how the player characters react to their presence. Unknown to the player characters, unless they pass a daunting (D3) **Battle** test, two further Fremen are hidden off to one side, flanking the player characters, ready to attack should they make a hostile move.

The player characters have a tricky social challenge. Do they immediately enter into combat with the reclusive, notoriously hostile, natives, or try to **Communicate** with them? If the player characters are quick to reach for knives the gamemaster should remind them they are outnumbered and the Fremen appear to be experienced fighters. Perhaps the Fremen can be bought off, for a suitable payment from the player characters, but this is unlikely as the player characters are carrying little of value and the Fremen do not take promises instead of something they can carry.

Perhaps the Fremen can be convinced of the player characters' worth to them in other ways. The wrong choice could end in death for either party, or the start of a Fremen vendetta against the House.

If the player characters do nothing, at length the Fremen chief calls out to them and asks what they are doing here. Jellicoe, if still with the player characters, advises them to consider carefully before replying, but not to take too long. If the player characters act suspiciously, or lie badly, or reply with disrespect, aggression, hostility, or assumed authority, the Fremen quickly turn hostile and demand that the player characters show them—and the desert—respect. The player characters will need to defuse tempers with an immediate **Communicate** test, the Difficulty depending on how they have behaved. If they have been respectful and polite it will be average (D1) but if they have been rude and aggressive it might easily be dire (D4). If the test fails, the Fremen bring out their weapons and attack—or worse—simply vanish and leave the player characters to the desert.

The gamemaster should handle this combat carefully, reviewing the rules on p.174-176. This may be the players' first experience with combat using these rules, and it is encouraged that their introduction emphasizes

tactics, strategic thinking, and the potential deadliness of plunging into combat in unfamiliar terrain against unknown enemies.

See p.280 for a writeup of the Fremen warriors. Each is equipped with crysknives, full desert gear, and wearing Fremen-made stillsuits. They have ample water, and were just setting out from their home sietch, on a mission they will not divulge. There will be at least as many as two per player character.

The Fremen are not fanatics, and fight cannily, using the terrain as cover, attacking, and then moving. The Fremen do not regard the player characters as worth losing the lives of any of their own. If the player characters put up a strong resistance and kill or seriously wound one or more of the Fremen, the desert band tactically retreats, carrying off any fallen allies, disappearing into the dunes.

The player characters have now made an implacable enemy.

TRADING WITH THE FREMEN

If the player characters manage to not provoke the Fremen, Drasil the chief asks for a gift in return for granting them safe passage through the desert. The Fremen do not want the characters' 'inferior' stillsuits—nor would even they sentence someone to walk the desert without one—but they do accept containers of precious water or personal weapons, though not personal shields, which they scoff at. The player characters might consider this a small price to pay for surviving an encounter with the Fremen.

If the player characters show the Fremen respect and gift them willingly and appropriately, the Fremen chief Drasil becomes well disposed towards them, and offers them a gift in return. It is a Fremen thumper device, which he explains how to use. The player characters have made a potential ally.

The scene ends with a crackle on the player characters' comms devices. A scout 'thopter from a nearby harvester, loyal to their House, has followed their trail, but does not know their exact location. The nervous thopter pilot is reluctant to set down in the desert with reports of Fremen about, so instead he directs the player characters to his harvester, the Alberich, not far away.

If they have a wounded person with them, a challenging (D2) **Communicate** test convinces the pilot to land and pick the wounded pilot up, or any player characters injured in battle with the Fremen. They can also emphasize how it is essentially their right as representatives of their House, which does not require a test but earns them gruff, unfriendly service. The 'thopter is a light one, with a cramped cabin able to fit only two additional people, so the rest must continue on foot.

Whichever the case, the Fremen disappear into the dunes before the 'thopter can see them.

ACT III THE ALBERICH

Either onboard the scout 'thopter or by following it while it circles overhead, the dusty, weary player characters reach the harvester. Alpha-Barrex-8—also known as the Alberich—is a dirty, noisy, belching and angular beetle-shaped monstrosity, sucking up spice from the desert floor. The wind and dust swirling around the harvester's enormous tracks make standing outside the vehicle an unpleasant place to be for any amount of time.

The scout 'thopter that found them buzzes away to continue its duties after the interruption.

BOARDING THE HARVESTER

A hatch opens up high on the harvester's side and a big, filthy, thuggish spice worker demands to know who the player characters are and what they want.

"We've got a job to do here. We can't stop operations just to pick up idiots who can't keep their 'thopter up in the air!"

In truth, the thuggish spice worker Metzoz is running a lucrative spice smuggling racket from the Alberich and does not want anyone climbing on board and snooping around. The player characters must successfully

Communicate (challenging, D2) how it is to her advantage to let them onboard, or else stamp their authority on the thug and her crew with a daunting (D3) **Discipline** test. Alternatively, there is always the option of physically forcing their way on board.

If the player characters manage to climb on board the Alberich and take shelter from the desert at last, they find a cramped, badly-lit interior that is louder and filthier than the carryall Grief, and even more suffused with the cinnamon scent of spice.

JOTHI METZOS, HARVESTER CAPTAIN (NOTABLE SUPPORTING CHARACTER)

Jothi Metzoz is the thuggish skipper of the harvester Alberich. Big, crude, and unafraid of a little trouble, she runs a neat little smuggling racket, skimming off substantial amounts of raw spice and selling it to private enterprises. She pockets much of the profit herself but shares enough with the rest of the harvester crew to make it worth their while. That and the threat of being thrown out of the harvester if they say anything keeps them in line. Metzoz is direct and lacking in any cunning, but is greedy and can be bought off, or intimidated by anyone able to prove they are tougher than she herself is.

Traits: Spice Worker, Captain

Talents:

○ **Find Trouble:** May contact the criminal underworld.

Assets: Maula Pistol, Harvester Captain, Criminal Contacts

DRIVE	STATEMENT	
DUTY:	5	
FAITH:	6	
JUSTICE:	5	
POWER:	7	Everyone has an angle.
TRUTH:	5	
SKILL	FOCUSES	
BATTLE:	7	
COMMUNICATE:	6	Deceit
DISCIPLINE:	8	Spice Harvesting
MOVE:	7	
UNDERSTAND:	6	

CORINTH EULER, MECHANIC

(NOTABLE SUPPORTING CHARACTER)

Corinth Euler is a capable mechanic who has worked in the spice mining industry for years. But he has never advanced far due to his surly personality and lack of respect for his superiors. He is not particularly interested in Metzoz's smuggling racket but is so badly disposed to the House—especially their representative Globus on the Grief—that he is content to take his cut and keep quiet.

Euler takes any accusation that he might have sabotaged equipment, or simply caused a malfunction through technical incompetence, as a slight on his reputation and becomes outright hostile to his accusers.

Traits: Mechanic, Hard Worker

Talents:

- ❖ **Dedication:** If there is no Threat at the start of a scene, Euler may roll 1D20 under his Discipline to gain 1 Threat.

Assets: Toolkit, Knife

DRIVE		STATEMENT
DUTY:	7	I cover the back of those who cover mine.
FAITH:	6	
JUSTICE:	5	
POWER:	5	
TRUTH:	5	
SKILL		FOCUSES
BATTLE:	5	
COMMUNICATE:	4	
DISCIPLINE:	6	Survival (Desert)
MOVE:	7	Pilot (Ornithopter)
UNDERSTAND:	5	

THE CREW OF THE ALBERICH

(MINOR SUPPORTING CHARACTERS)

This rough group of spice harvesters are used to life in the cramped and noisy environment of the Alberich. They've worked for whomever pays them and have no particular loyalty to the player characters' House. Native to Arrakis, they are from the 'pyon' class, city-bred and without the hardy resilience of the Fremens, whom they despise and fear. Though they are compliant with Metzoz's smuggling and have enjoyed the personal gains, they know that exposure could lead to their deaths, so they are reluctant to fight the player characters, unless prodded by Metzoz, Obregon, or both.

Traits: Spice Workers

Drive: 4 (use for all Drives)

Talents: None

Assets: Tools, Knife

SKILL		FOCUSES
BATTLE:	4	
COMMUNICATE:	5	
DISCIPLINE:	5	Spice Harvesting
MOVE:	6	
UNDERSTAND:	4	